

HSK 4 Grammar & Syntax

Complete Pattern Reference

汉语水平考试四级·语法句型指南

HSK 3.0 Standard · Words 1001–2000

Formal registers · Discourse connectors · Advanced conditionals

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About HSK 4 Grammar

HSK 4 marks a decisive shift in register. Where HSK 2–3 grammar mostly extends spoken patterns you already know, HSK 4 introduces the connective tissue of written and formal Chinese: discourse-level connectors (然而, 于是, 从而), formal modal and causal structures (由于, 将, 使), and a suite of advanced conditionals and concessives (即使, 尽管, 无论). Many of these have colloquial equivalents you already know — the table below maps them.

Colloquial (HSK 2–3)	Formal/Written (HSK 4)	Meaning
但是	然而	but; however
因为…所以	由于…因此	because…therefore
虽然…但是	尽管…仍然	although…still
如果不…	否则	if not; otherwise
不管…都	无论/不论…都	no matter what
不但…而且	不仅…还/而且	not only…but also
还	仍然/仍	still
要	将/将要	will; about to
让 + sb. + V	使/令 + sb./sth. + V	make/cause

Pattern 1 · 尽管…还是/仍然 — Even Though (Strong Concessive)
尽管

Structure: 尽管 + Concession, 还是/仍然 + Outcome	Meaning: Despite the concession, the outcome persists — stronger than 虽然
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尽管 (jǐnguǎn) is a more formal and emphatic concessive than 虽然. Where 虽然 simply acknowledges a fact before introducing a contrast, 尽管 stresses that the concession is a significant obstacle that is nevertheless overcome. The result clause typically uses 还是 or 仍然 (both meaning 'still'), reinforcing that the outcome is unchanged despite everything.

尽管工作很累，他还是坚持每天学习。

Jǐnguǎn gōngzuò hěn lèi, tā hái shì jiān chí měi tiān xué xī.

Despite being exhausted from work, he still persists in studying every day.

尽管困难重重，他们仍然没有放弃。

Jǐnguǎn kùnnán chóngchóng, tāmen réng rán méi yǒu fàng qì.

Despite countless difficulties, they still did not give up.

尽管下着大雨，比赛仍然继续进行。

Jǐnguǎn xià zhe dà yǔ, bǐsài réng rán jì xù jìn xíng.

Despite the heavy rain, the competition still continued.

Pattern	Nuance	Result connector
虽然…但是	neutral concession	但是/可是
尽管…还是	concession is a real obstacle	还是/仍然

Subject placement: when one subject covers both clauses, it goes before 尽管 (他尽管很累，还是…) or after 尽管 (尽管他很累，还是…). Both orders are fine. With two different subjects, each goes after its own connector.

Pattern 2 · 即使/哪怕…也 — Even If…Still (Counterfactual)
即使…也

Structure: 即使/哪怕 + Hypothetical condition, 也 + Result	Meaning: Even in an imagined or extreme scenario, the result holds
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即使 (jíshǐ) introduces a hypothetical or extreme scenario — something that may not be true — to insist the conclusion stands regardless. It is counterfactual: the speaker is not claiming the condition is real. 哪怕 (nǎpà) is a more colloquial synonym. The result clause uses 也 (never 还是 or 仍然 alone).

即使很难，我也要坚持学下去。

Jíshǐ hěn nán, wǒ yě yào jiān chí xué xià qù.

Even if it's very hard, I will still persist in studying.

哪怕只有一点时间，他也会利用来学习。

Nǎpà zhǐ yǒu yī diǎn shí jiān, tā yě huì lì yòng lái xué xī.

Even if there's only a little time, he will use it to study.

即使失败了，我也不后悔。

Jíshǐ shībài le, wǒ yě bù hòuhuǐ.

Even if I fail, I won't regret it.

Connector	Condition type	Result particle	Register
即使…也	hypothetical / extreme	也	formal/written
哪怕…也	hypothetical / extreme	也	colloquial
就算…也	hypothetical / concessive	也	colloquial
尽管…还是	real concession	还是/仍然	formal

The critical distinction: 尽管 = real concession (the obstacle exists); 即使 = counterfactual or hypothetical (the speaker is imagining a scenario). 'Even though I'm tired' → 尽管 (I am tired). 'Even if I were tired' → 即使 (imagined).

Pattern 3 · 无论/不论…都 — No Matter What (Formal) 无论…都

Structure: 无论/不论 + Question-word phrase, 都 + Result

Meaning: The result holds across all possible values of the variable

无论 (wúlùn) and 不论 (búlùn) are the formal written equivalents of 不管 (HSK 3). They are interchangeable in most contexts. Like 不管, they take question-word phrases as their condition (怎么, 什么, 多 + Adj, A不A, A还是B) and 都 is mandatory in the result clause.

无论遇到什么困难，都不要放弃。

Wúlùn yùdào shénme kùnnan, dōu bú yào fàngqì.

No matter what difficulties you encounter, don't give up.

不论结果怎么样，我都会支持你。

Búlùn jiéguǒ zěnmeyàng, wǒ dōu huì zhīchí nǐ.

Regardless of the outcome, I will support you.

无论多忙，他每天都坚持锻炼。

Wúlùn duō máng, tā měi tiān dōu jiānchí duànliàn.

No matter how busy he is, he exercises every day without fail.

无论你去还是不去，都要告诉我。

Wúlùn nǐ qù háishì bú qù, dōu yào gàosu wǒ.

Whether you go or not, you must tell me.

无论/不论 are used in formal writing and prepared speech. 不管 (HSK 3) covers the same ground in casual conversation. All three are correct; register determines the choice.

Pattern 4 · 由于…因此/所以 — Due To…Therefore (Formal Causal) 由于…因此

Structure: 由于 + Cause, 因此/所以 + Result	Meaning: Formal written equivalent of 因为…所以
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由于 (yóuyóu) introduces causes in written, formal, or news-register Chinese. It is often paired with 因此 (yīncǐ, 'therefore') or 所以. The cause with 由于 is typically an objective situation or fact — not a personal feeling or choice, which would be more natural with 因为.

由于天气原因，航班被取消了。

Yóuyóu tiānqì yuányīn, hángbān bèi qǔxiāo le.
Due to weather conditions, the flight was cancelled.

由于缺乏经验，他在工作中遇到了很多困难。

Yóuyóu quēfá jīngyàn, tā zài gōngzuò zhōng yùdào le hěn duō kùnnán.
Due to lack of experience, he encountered many difficulties at work.

由于双方意见不同，会议没有达到预期结果。

Yóuyóu shuāngfāng yìjiàn bùtóng, huìyì méiyǒu dá dào yùqī jiéguǒ.
Due to differing opinions between both sides, the meeting did not achieve the expected outcome.

Connector	Register	Typical cause type
因为…所以	colloquial/neutral	personal reasons, feelings, choices
由于…因此	formal/written	objective situations, external factors
由于…所以	semi-formal	mixed; 所以 slightly less formal than 因此

由于 cannot be used for speaker's internal reasoning the way 因为 can. 你为什么迟到？— 因为堵车 / 由于堵车 (too formal for a spoken question). Headlines and reports: 由于 is almost always preferred.

Pattern 5 · 于是 — Thereupon; As a Result (Narrative) 于是

Structure: Situation, 于是 + Consequent action	Meaning: Speaker/agent responds to the situation with an action — narrative connector
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于是 (yúshì) connects two events where the second is a natural or intentional consequence of the first. Unlike 所以 (logical conclusion), 于是 specifically narrates what someone did in response — it is event-driven and almost always triggers an action, not a state.

他发现钱包丢了，于是赶紧回去找。

Tā fāxiàn qiánbāo diū le, yúshì gǎnjīn huíqù zhǎo.
He found that his wallet was gone, so he hurried back to look for it.

外面开始下雨，于是我们决定取消野餐。

Wàimiàn kāishǐ xià yǔ, yúshì wǒmen juéding qǔxiāo yěcān.
It started to rain outside, so we decided to cancel the picnic.

会议结束了，于是大家各自回家。

Huìyì jiéshù le, yúshì dàjiā gèzì huí jiā.
The meeting ended, whereupon everyone went home.

Connector	Type of link	Typical clause type
所以	logical consequence/conclusion	state, fact, or repeated pattern
于是	narrative consequent action	specific action taken in response
因此	formal logical consequence	formal conclusions, reports

Pattern 6 · 然而 — However; Yet (Formal Contrast) 然而

Structure: Statement A. 然而, Statement B.	Meaning: B is unexpected or contrary to A — formal written contrast
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然而 (rán'ér) is the written-language equivalent of 但是/可是. It marks an unexpected reversal or complication after a stated situation. It almost always opens a new sentence (rarely a clause), giving it more rhetorical weight. Common in news, essays, and formal speech.

他的计划听起来很完美。然而，实施起来却困难重重。

Tā de jìhuà tīngqǐlái hěn wánměi. Rán'ér, shíshī qǐlái què kùnnán chóngchóng.

His plan sounded perfect. However, implementing it proved extremely difficult.

科技的发展带来了许多便利。然而，也产生了新的问题。

Kējì de fāzhǎn dài lái le hǎn duō biànlì. Rán'ér, yě chǎnshēng le xīn de wèntí.

Technological development has brought great convenience. Yet it has also created new problems.

然而 is rarely used in ordinary conversation — 但是 or 可是 are natural there. In essays and formal writing, 然而 adds rhetorical elevation. Its counterpart 而 (ér) is an even more compact formal contrast particle: 他努力而不急躁 (He is hardworking yet not impatient).

Pattern 7 · 否则 — Otherwise; If Not 否则

Structure: Condition / instruction. 否则, + Consequence.	Meaning: States what will happen if the condition is not met
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否则 (fǒuzé) is a compact way to express 'if not, then...'. It collapses the negative conditional into a single connector — cleaner in writing than otherwise repeating 如果 + negation. It often follows an instruction or warning.

请按时提交作业，否则会影响成绩。

Qǐng ànshí tījiāo zuòyè, fǒuzé huì yǐngxiǎng chéngjī.

Please submit homework on time; otherwise it will affect your grade.

你必须注意饮食，否则健康会出问题。

Nǐ bìxū zhùyì yǐnshí, fǒuzé jiànkāng huì chū wèntí.

You must watch your diet, otherwise your health will suffer.

要努力复习，否则考试就会不通过。

Yào nǔlì fùxí, fǒuzé kǎoshì jiù huì bù tōngguò.

You need to review diligently, otherwise you'll fail the exam.

否则 = 如果不(这样), 就... condensed into one word. It always looks backward to an implied condition. Synonyms in descending formality: 不然 (colloquial spoken) → 否则 (neutral/formal) → 不然的话 (conversational workaround).

Pattern 8 · 随着 — Along With; As (Something Changes) 随着

Structure: 随着 + Changing factor, Result clause

Meaning: The result co-varies with or develops alongside the factor

随着 (suízhe) marks a proportional or concurrent development — as X changes or progresses, Y develops in tandem. It is closely related to 越来越 but describes the driving factor explicitly. Very common in analytical writing.

随着科技的发展，人们的生活越来越方便了。

Suízhe kējì de fāzhǎn, rénmen de shēnghuó yuèlái yuè fāngbiàn le.

As technology develops, people's lives become increasingly convenient.

随着学习的深入，我发现汉语越来越有趣。

Suízhe xuéxí de shēnrù, wǒ fāxiàn Hànyǔ yuèlái yuè yǒuqù.

As I study more deeply, I find Chinese more and more interesting.

随着年龄的增长，他越来越成熟。

Suízhe niánlíng de zēngzhǎng, tā yuèlái yuè chéngshú.

As he grows older, he becomes more and more mature.

The noun after 随着 is typically a process or change: 发展 (development), 增长 (growth), 提高 (improvement), 深入 (deepening). 随着 + noun + 的 + process noun is a very common written formula.

Pattern 9 · 竟然 — Unexpectedly; To One's Surprise 竟然

Structure: 竟然 + Verb / Adjective

Meaning: The outcome is surprising or contrary to what was expected

竟然 (jīngrán) marks a strong sense of surprise — the speaker did not expect the action or state to be true. It can express pleasant surprise, disbelief, or indignation depending on context.

他竟然一个人完成了整个项目！

Tā jīngrán yī gè rén wánchéng le zhěnggè xiàngmù!

He actually completed the entire project by himself! (surprised)

这么难的题，她竟然五分钟就做完了。

Zhème nán de tí, tā jīngrán wǔ fēnzhōng jiù zuò wán le.

Such a hard problem — she actually finished it in five minutes!

他竟然忘记了我们的约会。

Tā jīngrán wàng jì le wǒmen de yuēhuì.

He actually forgot our appointment. (indignant surprise)

居然 (jūrán) is an HSK 5 synonym with nearly identical meaning and usage — it leans slightly more toward indignation/disbelief. 竟然 can be positive surprise; 居然 often implies the speaker is slightly offended. Both go directly before the verb.

Pattern 10 · 仍然 / 仍 — Still; As Before (Formal 还) 仍然

Structure: 仍然 / 仍 + Verb / Adjective

Meaning: A state or action continues unchanged from a previous time

仍然 (réngrán) and its contracted form 仍 are the formal written equivalents of 还 (hái, 'still'). They appear in essays, reports, and news. In speech, 还 is the natural choice; 仍然/仍 would sound bookish.

尽管困难很多，他仍然坚持完成了学业。

Jǐnguǎn kùnnan hěnduō, tā réngrán jiānchí wánchéng le xuéyè.

Despite many difficulties, he still persisted and completed his studies.

问题仍未得到解决。

Wèntí réng wèi dédào jiějué.

The problem has still not been resolved.

多年过去了，她仍然记得那次旅行。

Duō nián guòqù le, tā réngrán jìde nà cì lǚxíng.

Many years have passed, and she still remembers that trip.

仍 alone is more compact and literary; 仍然 is the standard form in formal prose. In written Chinese, 仍未 (still haven't) and 仍在 (still in/at) are very common collocations.

Pattern 11 · 难道…吗 — Rhetorical Questions 难道…吗

Structure: 难道 + Statement + 吗?

Meaning: Speaker strongly implies the opposite — rhetorical, not genuine question

难道 (nándào) turns a statement into a rhetorical question that strongly implies its own negation. The speaker is not asking for information — they are asserting that the stated proposition is clearly false or unacceptable. The final 吗 is optional but common.

难道你不知道这件事吗?

Nándào nǐ bù zhīdào zhè jiàn shì ma?

Surely you know about this? (implying: of course you know)

你说了那么多，难道只是为了开玩笑?

Nǐ shuō le nàme duō, nándào zhǐshì wèile kāiwánxiào?

You said so much — surely not just to joke around?

这么简单的问题，难道你也不会?

Zhème jiǎndān de wèntí, nándào nǐ yě bù huì?

Such a simple question — are you really saying you can't do it either?

难道 questions are answered with the proposition itself, not '是/不是': 难道你不累吗? — 我确实很累 (acknowledging the implied fact). Confusing 难道 with genuine yes/no questions leads to misunderstandings.

Pattern 12 · 究竟 — After All; Exactly (Emphasis in Questions) 究竟

In questions — demands a definite, clear answer

Structure: 究竟 + Question word + ...?

Meaning: Presses for a specific answer; expresses impatience or urgency

你究竟想要什么？

Nǐ jiūjìng xiǎng yào shénme?

What exactly do you want? (I need a clear answer)

他究竟去没去？

Tā jiūjìng qù méi qù?

Did he go or not? (tell me once and for all)

In statements — 'after all; when all is said and done'

Structure: Subject + 究竟 + 是/还是 + Fact

Meaning: Concedes or acknowledges an underlying truth

他究竟还是孩子，不能要求太高。

Tā jiūjìng hái shì gè hái zǐ, bù néng yāoqiú tài gāo.

After all, he is still just a child — you can't expect too much.

究竟 in questions is stronger than 到底 (dàodǐ, HSK 4 #1141) — both demand clarity, but 究竟 is more formal.

到底 is more colloquial and can also mean 'in the end' when used in statements. At this level, learn both as a pair.

Pattern 13 · 不得不 / 只好 — Have No Choice But To 不得不 / 只好

不得不 (bùdébù) — compelled by circumstance

Structure: 不得不 + Verb

Meaning: Cannot avoid doing X; forced to do it against preference

他生病了，不得不取消了旅行计划。

Tā shēngbìng le, bùdébù qǔxiāo le lǚxíng jìhuà.

He fell ill and had no choice but to cancel the travel plan.

为了养家糊口，他不得不接受了这份工作。

Wèile yǎng jiā hú kǒu, tā bùdébù jiēshòu le zhè fèn gōngzuò.

To support his family, he had no choice but to accept the job.

只好 (zhǐhǎo) — resigned acceptance

Structure: 只好 + Verb

Meaning: The only available option; settling for the best of a bad situation

票卖完了，我们只好明天再来。

Piào mài wán le, wǒmen zhǐhǎo míngtiān zài lái.

The tickets were sold out, so we had no choice but to come back tomorrow.

Expression

Nuance

Typical trigger

不得不	forced; strong external compulsion	circumstances, obligations, necessity
只好	resigned; best option available	blocked first choice; compromise
只能	the only possibility; no other way	logical impossibility of alternatives

Pattern 14 · 不仅/不光…还/而且 — Not Only…But Also (Formal) 不仅…而且

Structure: 不仅/不光 + A, 还/而且/也 + B Meaning: Formal escalation: B goes beyond A

不仅 (bùjǐn) and 不光 (bùguāng) are the formal equivalents of 不但 (HSK 3). 不仅 is more formal and common in writing; 不光 is semi-formal and slightly more colloquial. The second clause still uses 还/也/而且 to introduce B.

他不仅汉语说得好，而且还会写书法。

Tā bùjǐn Hànyǔ shuō de hǎo, érqiě hái huì xiě shūfǎ.

He not only speaks Chinese well, but can also do calligraphy.

这个问题不光影响了个人，还影响了整个社会。

Zhègè wèntí bùguāng yǐngxiǎng le gèrén, hái yǐngxiǎng le zhěnggè shèhuì.

This issue affected not only individuals, but also society as a whole.

Escalation of formality: 不但 < 不光 < 不仅. All mean 'not only'. For the HSK 4 exam, 不仅 and 不光 are active vocabulary; ensure you can recognise 不仅…也 and 不仅…而且 as complete patterns.

Pattern 15 · 此外 / 另外 — Moreover; In Addition 此外 / 另外

Both connectors add a new point to what has already been said, but they differ in register and the relationship between the clauses they connect.

Word	Register	Relationship
此外 cǐwài	formal/written	adds a distinct, supplementary point
另外 lìngwài	neutral/colloquial	adds a related but separate matter

本次活动免费参加。此外，还提供免费午餐。

Běn cì huódòng miǎnfèi cānjiā. Cǐwài, hái tígōng miǎnfèi wǔcān.

Participation in this event is free. In addition, a free lunch will also be provided.

我今天有个会议，另外还要准备一个报告。

Wǒ jīntiān yǒu gè huìyì, lìngwài hái yào zhǔnbèi yī gè bàogào.

I have a meeting today, and I also need to prepare a report.

此外 typically opens a new sentence and is more formal. 另外 can appear within a sentence and is natural in speech. Neither implies causation or consequence — they are purely additive.

Pattern 16 · 将 / 将要 — Will; Shall (Formal Future) 将 / 将要

Structure: 将 / 将要 + Verb

Meaning: Formal written marker of imminent or certain future action

将 (jiāng) and 将要 (jiāngyào) mark the future in formal written Chinese — the written equivalent of the spoken 要/会. They appear in official announcements, reports, and formal speeches. 将 alone is more compact and literary; 将要 includes more of a sense of 'about to'.

会议将于明天上午九点开始。

Huìyì jiāng yú míngtiān shàngwǔ jiǔ diǎn kāishǐ.

The meeting will begin at 9 AM tomorrow.

这项政策将在明年正式实施。

Zhè xiàng zhèngcè jiāng zài míngnián zhèngshì shíshī.

This policy will be officially implemented next year.

飞机将要降落，请系好安全带。

Fēijī jiāngyào jiànguò, qǐng jìhǎo ānquándài.

The plane is about to land; please fasten your seatbelts.

In conversation, 要/会/快要 are the natural equivalents. 将 in speech sounds stiff. In formal writing, using 要 where 将 is expected signals an informal or careless register choice.

Pattern 17 · 从此 — From This Point On; Since Then 从此

Structure: (Past event.) 从此, + New situation/behaviour.

Meaning: Marks a turning point after which things changed permanently

从那次经历之后，他从此不再喝酒了。

Cóng nà cì jīnglǐ zhīhòu, tā cóngcǐ bú zài hē jiǔ le.

After that experience, he never drank alcohol again from that point on.

他们在那次旅行中相识，从此成了好朋友。

Tāmen zài nà cì lǚxíng zhōng xiāngshí, cóngcǐ chéng le hǎo péngyou.

They met on that trip and from then on became good friends.

从此 anchors to a past pivot event, after which a sustained change begins. It is more literary than 从那以后 (cóng nà yǐhòu, from then on) but they are often interchangeable. Do not confuse with 从来 (habit across all time) — 从此 implies a specific turning point.

Pattern 18 · 对于 vs. 关于 — Regarding / About 对于 vs. 关于

Both 对于 and 关于 introduce a topic, but they frame it differently. Confusing them is a very common HSK 4 writing error.

Prep.	Frame	What follows
对于 duìyú	Attitude / reaction / evaluation toward something	opinions, feelings, assessments; usually followed by a verb of judgment

关于 guānyú	Topic of discourse / scope definition	what the sentence / document is about; typically opens a sentence or title
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对于这个问题，我有不同的看法。

Duìyú zhègè wèntí, wǒ yǒu bùtóng de kànfǎ.

Regarding this problem, I have a different view.

关于这次考试的安排，请看通知。

Guānyú zhè cì kǎoshì de ānpái, qǐng kàn tōngzhī.

Regarding the arrangements for this exam, please see the notice.

Test: substitute 'about' in English. If it means 'My attitude ABOUT this' → 对于. If it means 'the matter/topic OF this' → 关于. 关于 often appears as a sentence-opener defining scope; 对于 is embedded in the predicate expressing reaction.

Pattern 19 · 尤其(是) — Especially; Particularly 尤其

Structure: General statement. 尤其(是) + Specific case.	Meaning: Picks out one item from a set as the most noteworthy
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他喜欢运动，尤其是游泳。

Tā xǐhuan yùndòng, yóuqí shì yóuyóǒng.

He likes sports, especially swimming.

我在学习中文，尤其对汉字感兴趣。

Wǒ zài xuéxí Zhōngwén, yóuqí duì Hànzì gǎn xìngqù.

I'm studying Chinese; I'm especially interested in characters.

冬天要注意保暖，尤其是手和脚。

Dōngtiān yào zhùyì bǎonuǎn, yóuqí shì shǒu hé jiǎo.

In winter you must keep warm, especially your hands and feet.

尤其 can be followed directly by a noun, verb phrase, or preposition phrase. Adding 是 (尤其是) before a noun phrase is very natural. 特别(是) (tèbié shì) is a colloquial near-synonym covered at HSK 3.

Pattern 20 · 甚至 — Even; To The Extent That 甚至

Structure: Statement. 甚至 + Extreme case.	Meaning: Introduces the most extreme item in a progression to strengthen a point
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甚至 (shènzhì) escalates a statement to an extreme or unexpected degree. It introduces the case that best proves the point — the example that goes furthest. Unlike 连...都 (which isolates one unexpected case), 甚至 can introduce either a noun phrase or a full clause.

他学习非常刻苦，甚至周末也不休息。

Tā xuéxí fēicháng kèkǔ, shènzhì zhōumò yě bù xiūxi.

He studies extremely hard — he doesn't even rest on weekends.

这件事很重要，甚至影响到整个公司的发展。

Zhè jiàn shì hěn zhòngyào, shènzhì yǐngxiǎng dào zhěnggè gōngsī de fāzhǎn.

This matter is very important — it even affects the development of the entire company.

他非常忙，有时候甚至忘了吃饭。

Tā fēicháng máng, yǒu shíhòu shènzhì wàng le chīfàn.

He is extremely busy — sometimes he even forgets to eat.

甚至 vs. 连…都: 甚至 escalates progressively (and even…); 连…都 isolates the most unexpected single case (even this most extreme case…). They can overlap but 甚至 tends to work better with full clauses while 连…都 focuses on a single fronted element.

Pattern 21 · 既…又/也 — Both…And (Formal) 既…又

Structure: 既 + Quality/State A, 又/也 + Quality/State B

Meaning: Two coexisting qualities, with a formal register

既…又/也 is the formal written equivalent of 又…又 (HSK 3). It emphasises that two properties or conditions simultaneously characterise the same entity. Common in formal descriptions and evaluations.

这个方法既简单，又有效。

Zhège fāngfǎ jì jiǎndān, yòu yǒuxiào.

This method is both simple and effective.

他既是我的老师，也是我的朋友。

Tā jì shì wǒ de lǎoshī, yě shì wǒ de péngyou.

He is both my teacher and my friend.

学好外语既需要努力，也需要耐心。

Xué hǎo wàiyǔ jì xūyào nǔlì, yě xūyào nàixīn.

Learning a foreign language well requires both effort and patience.

既…又 vs. 又…又: functionally the same, but 既…又/也 is distinctly more formal. In casual speech, 又…又 is natural; in written Chinese and formal presentations, 既…又/也 is preferred. Use 既…也 (not 又) when the B predicate is a different verb type from A.

Pattern 22 · 等到 — By The Time; When (Temporal Clause) 等到

Structure: 等到 + Time/Event, 再/就 + Action

Meaning: When a future or past event is completed, then the action takes place

等到 (děngdào) introduces a temporal boundary — only after the stated event does the main action occur. It implies waiting for something to happen. The main clause often uses 再 (then, subsequently) or 就 (right then).

等到考试结束，我们再出去庆祝。

Děngdào kǎoshì jiéshù, wǒmen zài chūqù qīngzhù.

Once the exam is over, we'll go out to celebrate.

等到他明白过来，已经太晚了。

Děngdào tā míngbai guòlái, yǐjīng tài wǎn le.

By the time he came to understand, it was already too late.

等到下班了再说吧。

Děngdào xiàbān le zài shuō ba.

Let's talk about it after work.

等到 implies waiting for a future event before acting — there's a sense of temporal patience or dependency.

Contrast with 当…时 (when [at the moment]), which is more neutral and doesn't imply waiting.

Pattern 23 · 不断 — Unceasingly; Without Stopping 不断

Structure: 不断 + Verb / 不断 + 地 + Verb

Meaning: An action continues without interruption, often implying progress

他不断努力，终于实现了自己的梦想。

Tā búduàn nǔlì, zhōngyú shíxiàn le zìjǐ de mèngxiǎng.

Through unceasing effort, he finally realised his dream.

科技在不断发展，改变着我们的生活。

Kējì zài búduàn fāzhǎn, gǎibiàn zhe wǒmen de shēnghuó.

Technology is continuously developing, changing our lives.

词汇量不断积累，阅读能力也会提高。

Cíhuìliàng búduàn jīlěi, yuèdú nénglì yě huì tígāo.

As vocabulary accumulates unceasingly, reading ability will also improve.

不断 implies continuous progress or repetition without pause — it often carries a positive connotation of steady improvement. 一直 (continuously) focuses on uninterrupted duration; 不断 focuses on frequency and persistence without gaps.

Pattern 24 · 互相 — Mutually; Each Other 互相

Structure: 互相 + Verb

Meaning: Two or more parties do the action to/for each other simultaneously

我们应该互相帮助。

Wǒmen yīnggāi hùxiāng bāngzhù.

We should help each other.

两国之间需要互相理解和尊重。

Liǎng guó zhī jiān xūyào hùxiāng lǐjiě hé zūnzhòng.

Between the two countries there needs to be mutual understanding and respect.

学习语言需要互相交流。

Xuéxí yǔyán xūyào hùxiāng jiāoliú.

Learning a language requires mutual exchange.

互相 always requires a plural or compound subject (两人, 大家, 双方, 我们) — a single actor cannot act on themselves mutually. 彼此 (bǐcǐ) is a more formal/literary synonym meaning 'each other'.

Pattern 25 · 使 / 令 — Formal Causative: Make/Cause 使 / 令

Structure: 使/令 + Object + Verb/Adjective

Meaning: Cause something or someone to enter a new state — formal

使 (shǐ) and 令 (lìng) are the formal causative verbs in Chinese, equivalent to 'make/cause' in English formal writing. Unlike 让 (colloquial: let/make), 使 and 令 almost always take non-animate objects or abstract subjects/objects, and the result is a state change rather than an action.

这件事使我非常感动。

Zhè jiàn shì shǐ wǒ fēicháng gǎndòng.

This matter moved me deeply.

长期缺乏睡眠会使身体越来越差。

Chángqī quēfá shuìmián huì shǐ shēntǐ yuèlái yuè chà.

Prolonged lack of sleep will cause the body to deteriorate progressively.

他的话令我十分吃惊。

Tā de huà lìng wǒ shífēn chījīng.

His words utterly astonished me.

Causative	Register	Subject type	Object type
让	colloquial	people	people doing actions
使	formal	events, situations, factors	people/things entering states
令	formal/literary	events, words, situations	emotional state changes in people

令 collocates strongly with emotion words: 令人感动 (moving), 令人吃惊 (astonishing), 令人失望 (disappointing), 令人满意 (satisfying). These 令人 + emotion adjective compounds are very common in formal Chinese and worth memorising as chunks.

Pattern 26 · 重新 — Anew; Afresh (Fresh Start) 重新

Structure: 重新 + Verb

Meaning: The action is done again, but from the beginning, with a clean slate

重新 (chóngxīn) means doing something again from the very start — not just repeating a single step, but starting over. It implies a fresh approach, a new beginning, or a correction of what went wrong before. Contrast with 再 (again, once more — just a repetition).

他决定重新开始，认真学习汉语。

Tā juéding chóngxīn kāishǐ, rènzhēn xuéxí Hànyǔ.

He decided to start fresh and study Chinese seriously.

这份报告写得不好，请你重新写一遍。

Zhè fèn bàogào xiě de bù hǎo, qǐng nǐ chóngxīn xiě yī biàn.

This report isn't well-written; please write it again from scratch.

经历了失败之后，他重新找到了人生的目标。

Jīnglì le shībài zhīhòu, tā chóngxīn zhǎodào le rénshēng de mùbiāo.

After experiencing failure, he found a new life goal.

再 = repetition of an action (do it again); 重新 = restart from the beginning (do it afresh). 再做一遍 (do it one more time); 重新做 (redo it from the start). 这两者的区别很微妙，但很重要。(The distinction is subtle but important.)

Pattern 27 · 一方面…另一方面 — On One Hand…On The Other 一方面…另一方面

Structure: 一方面 + Aspect A, 另一方面 + Aspect B

Meaning: Two coexisting aspects of the same issue, often in tension

This structure presents two sides of one issue — not necessarily contradictory, but distinct perspectives or dimensions. It is a hallmark of balanced, analytical writing at HSK 4+ level.

学汉语一方面要多读多写，另一方面也要多听多说。

Xué Hànyǔ yīfāngmiàn yào duō dú duō xiě, lìng yī fāngmiàn yě yào duō tīng duō shuō.

Learning Chinese requires, on one hand, lots of reading and writing, and on the other, lots of listening and speaking.

这份工作一方面很有挑战性，另一方面薪水也不错。

Zhè fèn gōngzuò yīfāngmiàn hěn yǒu tiǎozhànxìng, lìng yī fāngmiàn xīnshuǐ yě búcuò.

This job is on one hand very challenging, and on the other hand the salary is also decent.

In formal writing, 一方面…另一方面 is often extended to three points: 一方面…另一方面…同时 (at the same time). This structure directly maps onto IELTS/HSK essay writing where presenting multiple dimensions is rewarded.

Pattern 28 · 不过 — Only; However (Discourse Connector) 不过

As a conjunction — 'however; but' (softer than 但是)

Structure: Statement A. 不过, Statement B.

Meaning: B mildly qualifies or softens A — less confrontational than 但是

这道题有点难，不过只要认真想，一定能做出来。

Zhè dào tí yǒudiǎn nán, búguò zhǐyào rènzhēn xiǎng, yīdìng néng zuò chūlái.

This problem is a bit hard, but as long as you think carefully, you'll definitely get it.

As an adverb — 'only; merely' (downplaying)

Structure: 不过 + Verb/Number + 罢了/而已

Meaning: Minimises or downplays a quantity, severity, or importance

这不过是个小问题，不用担心。

Zhè búguò shì gè xiǎo wèntí, búyòng dānxīn.

This is merely a small problem; don't worry.

他不过学了半年，汉语已经说得很好了。

Tā búguò xué le bàn nián, Hànyǔ yǐjīng shuō de hěn hǎo le.

He has only been studying for six months, yet his Chinese is already very good.

不过 as 'however' is softer and more conversational than 但是/然而. It signals a gentle qualification, not a strong contrast. 不过 as 'only/merely' often appears with 罢了 or 而已 at the end of the clause to further underplay the significance: 这不过是个玩笑罢了 (It was only a joke, that's all).

Quick Reference Summary

Pattern	Structure	Key Point
尽管…仍然	尽管 + Obstacle, 仍然/还是 + Outcome	Real obstacle, yet outcome persists; stronger than 虽然
即使…也	即使 + Hypothetical, 也 + Outcome	Counterfactual: even in imagined extreme, result holds
无论/不论…都	无论 + Q-word phrase, 都 + Result	Formal 不管; 都 mandatory; all conditions covered
由于…因此	由于 + Objective cause, 因此 + Result	Formal 因为…所以; objective/external causes only
于是	Situation. 于是, Action.	Narrative connector: acted in response; ≠ 所以 (logical)
然而	Statement A. 然而, Statement B.	Formal 但是; unexpected reversal; opens new sentence
否则	Instruction. 否则, Consequence.	= 如果不…就…; conditional consequence of non-compliance
随着	随着 + Changing factor, Result	Co-variation: as X develops, Y develops in tandem
竟然	竟然 + V/Adj	Surprising/unexpected outcome; can be positive or indignant
仍然/仍	仍然 + V/Adj	Formal 还 (still); 仍 = compact literary form
难道…吗	难道 + Statement + 吗?	Rhetorical: strongly implies opposite; not genuine question
究竟	究竟 + Q-word…? / 究竟还是 + Fact	Demands definitive answer / concedes underlying truth
不得不/只好	不得不 + V / 只好 + V	不得不 = forced; 只好 = resigned to best option
不仅…而且	不仅 + A, 而且/还 + B	Formal 不但; 不仅 > 不光 > 不但 in formality
此外/另外	此外, + New point. / 另外 + V	此外 = formal written addition; 另外 = neutral/spoken
将/将要	将/将要 + V	Formal written future; use 要/会 in speech
从此	(Past event.) 从此, + Change.	Turning point after which a change is sustained

对于 vs. 关于	对于 + attitude/judgment / 关于 + topic	对于 = toward (reaction); 关于 = about (topic scope)
尤其(是)	General. 尤其(是) + Specific.	Picks out the most noteworthy case in a set
甚至	Statement. 甚至 + Extreme case.	Escalates to extreme; can take full clause (cf. 连…都)
既…又/也	既 + A, 又/也 + B	Formal 又…又; two coexisting qualities
等到	等到 + Event, 再/就 + Action	Only after X does Y occur; implies waiting
不断	不断 + V	Unceasing; persistent without interruption (cf. 一直 = duration)
互相	互相 + V	Mutual/reciprocal; requires plural/compound subject
使/令	使/令 + Object + State	Formal causative; 使 = broad; 令 + emotion words common
重新	重新 + V	From scratch; fresh start (cf. 再 = just repeated once more)
一方面… 另一方面	一方面 A, 另一方面 B	Two dimensions of one issue; analytical writing staple
不过	A. 不过, B. / 不过 + only + 罢了	Soft contrast (milder than 但是) / downplaying adverb